movement prayer

Prayer Cycle

Overview

Everything we do as disciple makers flows out of our personal prayer practices. Until our own prayer life comes alive, we cannot effectively disciple others. If our aim is to multiply the kind of extraordinary prayer that births Disciple Making Movements, we must start by multiplying extraordinary prayer in our own lives. Most of us tend to focus on only a few aspects of prayer, usually petition and intercession with a little thanksgiving occasionally thrown in. Using the Prayer Cycle engages us in other aspects of prayer such as listening, waiting in surrender, confessing sin, and praying the Word.

The Prayer Cycle is a tool to bring balance to our prayer life and to multiply the kind of prayer that results in Disciple Making Movements.

Getting Started

Set a timer to help you know how much time to spend on each section of prayer, but don't become enslaved to the structure. After praying through the Cycle several times, you'll know the flow. But more importantly, you will learn to follow the lead of the Holy Spirit in what you pray and for how long. Remember, the Prayer Cycle is simply a tool to help bring balance to your prayer life.

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PRAYER CYCLE

Begin and End With Praise



Praying through the Prayer Cycle

PRAISE AND WORSHIP:
Start by giving God praise. Worship Him for Who He is, considering His character and His attributes.

WAITING ON THE LORD:
Use this time to surrender to Him afresh and ask Him to fill you with His Spirit. Invite Him to lay on your heart what He will. Rest in His presence.

CONFESSION OF GUILT AND SIN:
Ask the Holy Spirit to show you any areas of your life (attitudes, actions, acts of omission) that you need to confess to the Lord. Confess those things, and receive His forgiveness and cleansing.

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PRAYING SCRIPTURE:
Read a portion of scripture and use it as a direct prayer to God, or let it function as a guide for you to pray in your own words.

WATCHING:
"Seek His face always" (Psalm 105:4). As you gaze upon the beauty of the Lord, ask Him to show you anything He wants you to see from His Word, or any other spiritual insights that would guide your prayer time.

INTERCESSION:
Specifically ask God to work on behalf of others. You are engaging in spiritual warfare!

PETITIONS:
Talk with God specifically about your personal prayer requests.

THANKSGIVING:
Thank the Lord for what He has done in your life, in your family, and in your church and community.

SONG:
Sing or listen to songs of praise and worship, interacting with God as you listen to the lyrics. You could also sing portions of scripture, making your own melody.

CONTEMPLATION / MEDITATION:
Ask the Lord to guide your thoughts as you ponder what you read, prayed, and sang today.

LISTENING:
Quiet yourself to hear the Lord merging what you experienced in this hour into what He is now speaking to you.

PRAISE:
Praise the Lord for the opportunity to meet with Him, and for how He has spoken to you during this time. This is the preparation for you to go into the rest of your day with confidence in the Lord, His presence, and His ongoing work.

Source: From Dick Eastman's book *The Hour that Changes the World*

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TIPS:

- Keep a journal or notebook and pen ready to record any impressions the Lord gives you.
- If you struggle with distractions, consider writing out your prayers and interactions with God.
- When reading and praying the Word, Psalms and Proverbs are good books to begin with.
- During the time for intercession, pray for those on your 30-Day Prayer Calendar, Prayer Cards, or in your Circle of Accountability. These Prayer Tools are found under “Intercessory Prayer Tools” at movementprayer.org.
- If you have less than an hour to pray, simply divide the time you have by 12 to determine the time for each prayer segment.

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